

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 543

By Slater

A RESOLUTION to honor Joi Wasill upon receiving the Strong and Courageous Award.

WHEREAS, this General Assembly takes great pleasure in recognizing an individual who has demonstrated "strength and courage" in everyday life by utilizing her faith to positively affect her work, her neighborhood, and her community; and

WHEREAS, Joi Wasill is the president and director of Resource Development for DCO, an organization she has led for the past twenty-three years, serving over 280,000 students and youth in Tennessee, Alabama, and other states with sexual risk avoidance/abstinence education programs; and

WHEREAS, Mrs. Wasill's career in education began in 1988, after she completed teacher education certification courses at Middle Tennessee State University following the receipt of her Bachelor of Public Administration degree from the University of Mississippi; and

WHEREAS, as a public and private school secondary education teacher with more than three decades of experience, Joi Wasill understands the nature of the youth population and curriculum and instruction implementation and evaluation; and

WHEREAS, in addition to holding a teacher's license from the State of Tennessee, she is certified as a Sexual Risk Avoidance Education Specialist (SRAS) by the nation's top training organization in the field of sexual risk avoidance education; and

WHEREAS, a leader in her field, Mrs. Wasill is a member of Protect Child Health Coalition and has been a workshop leader and speaker at CareNet, the National Council for Adoption, and Teach Them Diligently conferences; and

WHEREAS, Mrs. Wasill has been duly recognized with a *Who's Who in American Educators* distinction, Young Educator of the Year Award from the Hendersonville Chamber of

Commerce, the "Top 30 Most Influential People in Sumner County" distinction, the Congressional Coalition on Adoption's Angel in Adoption Award, and the Impact Award on behalf of DCO from the White House Chamber of Commerce; and

WHEREAS, Mrs. Wasill enjoys the love and support of her husband of forty years and local business owner, Bill, and their son, Jacob, and daughter-in-law, Caitlyn; Joi and Bill Wasill have been active members of their church and community for many decades; and

WHEREAS, Joi Wasill has demonstrated strength and courage in the business and professional community in Sumner County; and

WHEREAS, Mrs. Wasill is committed to living her Christian faith to the fullest and helping others do likewise, and she is worthy of our approbation on this special occasion; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor and congratulate Joi Wasill upon receiving the Strong and Courageous Award from Welch College and extend to her our best wishes for much continued success.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.